



LME KNITTING PATTERN

🇳🇴 NORGE BUCKET HAT 🇳🇴

BIG BLOCK LETTERS, KNITTED IN

A summer hat in red cotton with "NORGE" in big white block letters around the front, and the Norwegian flag at the back. The letters and the flag are knitted right into the hat with colourwork, not embroidered on. The brim ripples like little splashes at the waterline. Fits child, woman and man. A lovely cheering hat for the football World Cup!

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TIP: Read the whole pattern through once before you start, and knit a little gauge swatch first. Then the hat comes out just the right size.

BEFORE YOU START

This hat is knitted round and round on a circular needle, from the bottom up. You begin with the wavy brim, knit stripes in white and navy blue, and carry on up. In the middle of the main part you knit in NORGE at the front and the flag at the back with colourwork, that is, right into the hat as you knit. Right at the end you bind off the top together.

WHAT YOU LEARN

- To knit in the round on a circular needle
- To make a wavy edge (it is almost magically easy)
- To knit stripes in several colours
- To knit in a pattern with two colours (stranded colourwork with floats)
- To bind off stitches so the top comes out neat and round

HOW HARD IS IT?

A little practised. You should be able to cast on stitches, knit in the round and knit two stitches together, and want to try two colours at once. Colourwork is new to many, but we take it step by step. The flag with three colours is the hardest bit, so take it easy and feel free to ask a grown-up for help there.

HOW TO READ THE NUMBERS

The pattern has three sizes. The numbers are always written like this:

child (woman) man → for example 84 (91) 98 stitches

For the child size use the first number. Woman uses the number in brackets, and man uses the last one.

Tip: Circle your own numbers in pencil before you start.

One step at a time, and it becomes a hat in the end.

WHAT YOU NEED

YARN

DROPS Paris (100% cotton, 50 g = approx. 75 m). A thick, soft cotton yarn knitted on a 5 mm needle, just right for this hat.

Colour	Child	Woman	Man
● Red (main colour)	2 balls	3 balls	3 balls
○ White or natural	1 ball	1 ball	1 ball
● Navy blue	1 ball	1 ball	1 ball

You can also use another cotton yarn that lists a 4.5 to 5 mm needle on the label, for example Hobbii Rainbow Cotton 8/8. Always check your gauge!

NEEDLES AND EQUIPMENT

- A **5 mm circular needle**, 40 cm long (the whole hat is knitted on this)
- **5 mm double-pointed needles** for the top, when it gets too tight on the circular needle
- A 4.5 mm circular needle if you knit loosely (the gauge swatch tells you)
- A **stitch marker** (or a little loop of yarn in another colour)
- A **tapestry needle with a blunt tip** for weaving in ends
- A little **graph paper and pencil** is handy, so you can sketch the pattern band before you knit
- Tape measure and scissors

GAUGE, THE SECRET KEY

17 stitches and 22 rows of stockinette on a 5 mm needle should make 10 × 10 cm.

How to check: Cast on 22 stitches and knit stockinette (back and forth: one row knit, one row purl) until the swatch is about 12 cm tall. Lay the swatch flat and measure how many stitches there are over 10 cm in the middle.

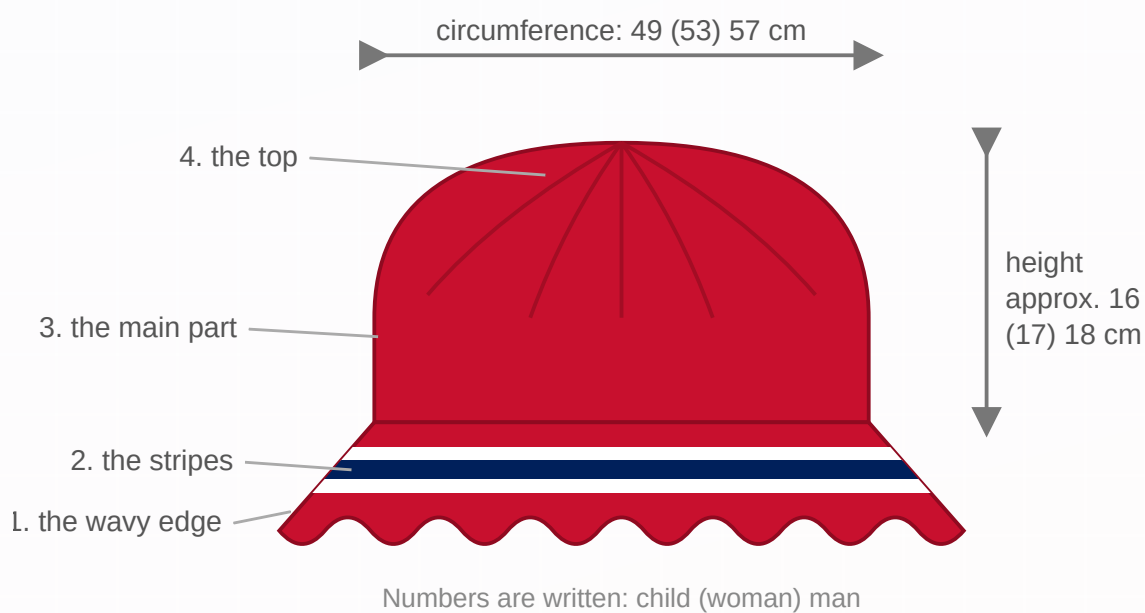
- More than 17 stitches? Switch to a thicker needle (5.5 mm).
- Fewer than 17 stitches? Switch to a thinner needle (4.5 mm).
- Exactly 17 stitches? Perfect, get going!

SIZES AND MEASUREMENTS

WHICH SIZE?

Measure around the head with a tape measure, right above the ears and eyebrows. Choose the size that fits the head measurement. The hat should be 3 to 4 cm smaller than the head, because knitting stretches.

	Child	Woman	Man
Fits head size	50–53 cm	54–57 cm	58–61 cm
Hat circumference	approx. 49 cm	approx. 53 cm	approx. 57 cm
Height (without brim)	approx. 16 cm	approx. 17 cm	approx. 18 cm
Stitches in the main part	84	91	98



Unsure of the size? Choose the largest, a bucket hat looks good sitting a little loose.

GLOSSARY

Term	Means
st	stitch
rnd	round, one whole lap around the hat
k	knit, ordinary knit stitches
k2tog	put the needle through two stitches at once and knit them as one. That gives one stitch fewer.
cast on	make the first stitches on the needle
bind off	reduce the number of stitches, so the hat gets narrower
stockinette in the round	when you knit in the round and knit every round, it comes out smooth and neat. Easier than knitting a hat back and forth!
colourwork	knitting with two colours on the same round, so a pattern appears right in the knitting
float	the yarn in the colour you are not using right now, which lies loosely on the back inside

HOW THE HAT IS BUILT UP

- 1 The wavy edge:** You cast on twice as many stitches as you need and knit stripes. When you then knit two and two stitches together, the edge folds into soft waves all by itself.
- 2 The stripes:** white, navy blue and white, like a little nod to the flag.
- 3 The main part with pattern:** you knit red for a little while, and then you knit in NORGE at the front and the flag at the back with two colours. After that red carries on up.
- 4 The top:** You bind off evenly in seven places, so the top comes out round like a bowl.

PART 1: THE BRIM WITH WAVES

Now we begin! Remember: child (woman) man. The whole brim is knitted, that is, stockinette in the round.

- 1 Cast on **168 (182) 196 st** in red on a 5 mm circular needle. Yes, it is a lot of stitches, but it is double on purpose: that is what makes the waves at the end.
- 2 Put the stitch marker on the needle. It shows where the round starts, and it ends up centre back on the hat.
- 3 Lay the knitting on the table and check that the cast-on edge is not twisted around the needle. All the stitches should point the same way, like a straight railway track. Then knit the first stitch, now the ring is closed!
- 4 Knit in the round in stripes, like this: **4 rnd red, 3 rnd white, 3 rnd navy blue, 3 rnd white**. When you change colour, just let the old yarn rest on the back. Do not cut the red, you need it again soon.
- 5 **The wave round (in red):** Knit k2tog all the way around. Count afterwards: Now you have **84 (91) 98 st**, and the brim curves out in lovely wavy splashes. Magic!

Dropped a stitch? Take it easy. Slip the needle back in and lift it up, or ask a grown-up for help. Nothing is ruined.

CHECKPOINT

- Do you have 84 (91) 98 stitches on the needle?
- Can you see three stripes: white, blue, white?
- Is the edge rippling? Then you are ready for part 2!

HOW TO KNIT IN THE PATTERN

Colourwork means you use two colours on the same round. You knit with red where the chart is red, and with white (or blue) where the chart shows it. The colour you are not using, you let hang loosely on the inside. The charts are on pages 9 and 10.

THE THREE THINGS YOU NEED TO KNOW

1

front



Knit each stitch in the colour the chart shows. Red is the background, white (or blue) is the pattern.

2

back



The colour you are not knitting with hangs loosely on the back. That is called a float. Keep it loose, not tight!

3

long floats



If there are more than 5 stitches between the colours, catch the long float under a stitch on the way. Then it does not dangle.

GOOD ADVICE

- Keep the floats loose. If you pull them tight, the hat bulges inward and the pattern hides. Better too loose than too tight.
- Read each row of the chart from **right to left**, from the bottom up. Then the letters come out the right way.
- Hold red on one finger and white on another, or put one down and pick up the other. Both work, choose whichever is easiest for you.
- Knit a little swatch in two colours first if you like, it makes the hat much easier.

Float = the yarn that lies behind. Loose float = a nice pattern.

PART 2: THE MAIN PART WITH PATTERN

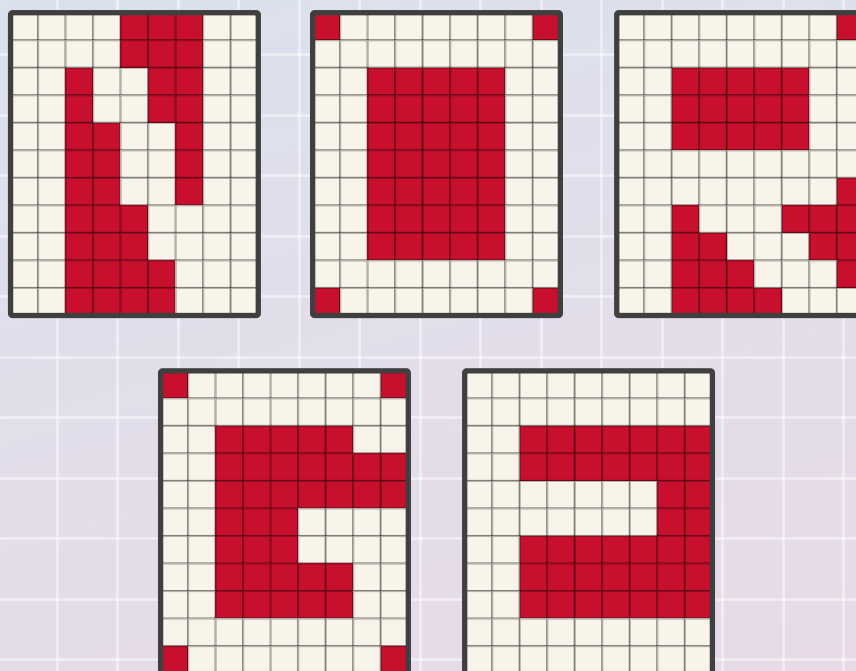
- 1 Carry on with red and knit round until the main part measures **about 3 cm** from the wave round. Then the pattern sits nicely in the lower part, as in the photo.
- 2 Now comes the **pattern band**. Follow the charts: NORGE at the front (page 9) and the flag at the back (page 10). Front and back are knitted on the same rounds, with red in between and at the sides.
- 3 Both NORGE and the flag start on the **same round**, the first in the pattern band. NORGE is tallest at 11 rounds, the flag 10. Above the flag you knit only red on the top round.
- 4 When the whole pattern band is knitted (11 rounds), cut off white and blue and leave about 5 cm hanging on the inside. You weave in the ends at the end.
- 5 Carry on with red alone, knitting round, until the main part measures **9 (10) 11 cm** from the wave round.

Always count the stitches before you start the pattern band. Getting the placement right is half the job!

CHART: NORGE

One square = one stitch. White square = knit with white. Red square = knit with red (the background). NORGE runs around the front in big block letters. Read each row from the bottom up, and from right to left. Each letter is 9 squares wide and 11 squares tall.

THE LETTERS (9 SQUARES WIDE, 11 SQUARES TALL)



WHERE ON THE HAT?

N		O		R		G		E
9 m	1 r	9 m	1 r	9 m	1 r	9 m	1 r	9 m

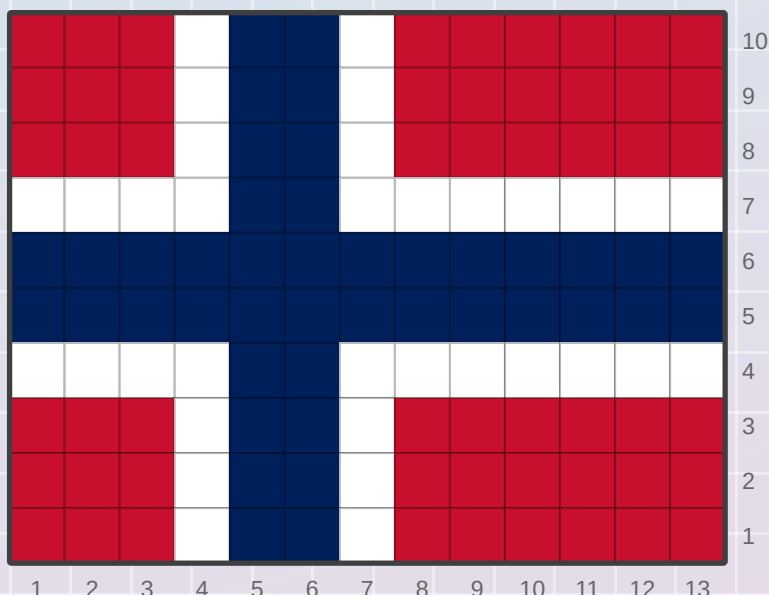
49 stitches wide in all

- **Across:** NORGE is centred at the front (directly opposite the stitch marker, which is at centre back). Count 25 stitches to the left of centre front; that is where the N starts. Leave 1 red stitch between the letters.
- **Upward:** All the letters start on the **first round** of the pattern band, and fill 11 rounds up. The flag at the back starts on the same round.
- The word is wide and wraps a little around towards the sides. It is meant to, just like on the NORWAY hat!

CHART: THE FLAG AT THE BACK

At centre back on the hat you knit in the Norwegian flag. The blue arm of the cross should run through unbroken, with a white border around it. Read from the bottom up, from right to left.

THE FLAG (13 SQUARES WIDE, 10 SQUARES TALL)



WHERE ON THE HAT?

- **Across:** Centre back is at the stitch marker. The flag is 13 stitches wide, so you count 6 stitches to the left and 6 to the right of the marker, with the marker in the 7th stitch (the middle of the flag).
- **Upward:** The flag starts on the **first round** of the pattern band, the same round as NORGE at the front, and fills 10 rounds up. Then the front and back stand at the same height.
- Between NORGE and the flag there is only red on each side. There the background colour gets to rest.

PART 3: THE TOP

The pattern band is done and you knit with red alone again. Now the hat gets narrower and narrower, until it closes at the top. You bind off in seven places on each decrease round. After decrease round 1, 2, 3 and 4 you knit an ordinary round without decreasing. From decrease round 5 you decrease on every round.

Decrease round	Child (84 st)	Woman (91 st)	Man (98 st)
1	*10 k, k2tog* = 77 st	*11 k, k2tog* = 84 st	*12 k, k2tog* = 91 st
2	*9 k, k2tog* = 70 st	*10 k, k2tog* = 77 st	*11 k, k2tog* = 84 st
3	*8 k, k2tog* = 63 st	*9 k, k2tog* = 70 st	*10 k, k2tog* = 77 st
etc.	knit one stitch fewer between the decreases on each decrease round		
second last	*1 k, k2tog* the whole round = 14 st		
last	k2tog the whole round = 7 st		

The stars mean: Repeat what is between them, all the way around. When it gets too tight on the circular needle, divide the stitches onto three or four double-pointed needles and carry on just as before.

- 1 Cut the yarn, but leave about 30 cm.
- 2 Thread the end onto the tapestry needle and pass it through the last 7 stitches as you lift them off the needle.
- 3 Pull tight so the hole closes, and fasten the yarn well on the inside. The hat itself is done!

FINISHING AND CARE

RIGHT AT THE END

- 1 Weave in all loose ends on the inside of the hat: Weave them back and forth through the back of the stitches with the tapestry needle, and trim what is left.
- 2 Look over the floats on the inside. If any are too tight, you can ease them a little looser with the needle so the pattern on the outside stays even.
- 3 Rinse the hat in lukewarm water, or wash it at 40 degrees in the machine (cotton takes it just fine).
- 4 Gently squeeze out the water with a towel. Do not wring! Lay the hat flat to dry, and shape the brim into nice waves while it is wet. However it dries is how it stays.

CHECKLIST FOR A FINISHED HAT

- All ends are woven in and the floats lie loosely on the inside
- NORGE sits at the front and the flag at the back
- The brim ripples and the top is round
- The hat is dry and ready for summer, sea and soft ice cream

Congratulations, you have knitted your very own NORGE hat!
Show it off on the 17th of May, at the cabin and in the boat.



Happy summer!

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